

Tinotenda M Madzunguruse

SOMMELIER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Target-driven Sommelier with strong wine knowledge, food and wine pairing capability, proven success in front-of-house service and sales-led environments across luxury hospitality, wine estates, and cruise operations. Experienced in staff scheduling, customer experience leadership, inventory and cash controls, wine club management, events execution, and performance reporting. Known for respectful, positive interaction that creates standout guest experiences while maintaining and growing sales targets.

EXPERIENCE

Sommelier

JUL 2025 — FEB 2026

Cunard Cruiseline (Queen Victoria)

- Deliver premium wine service and pairing recommendations across luxury dining venues and bars, maintaining Cunard guest standards.
- Drive beverage revenue through strategic upselling of wines, spirits, cocktails, digestifs and drinks packages aligned to targets.
- Promote and sell Cunard Wine Academy experiences: Lunch & Learn, wine tastings, and curated gourmet pairing dinners.
- Host guest-facing wine sessions using engaging storytelling around varietals, regions, tasting profiles, and service etiquette.
- Support daily service across breakfast/lunch/dinner including hot beverages and bar service during peak periods.
- Manage venue stock control: ensure inventory accuracy, coordinate orders via onboard stores/provisions, and maintain stock rotation.

Sommelier

AUG 2024 — JUN 2025

Bartinney Private Cellar

- Hosted structured tastings and tours, translating terroir, winemaking style, and sustainability into clear guest-friendly storytelling.
- Increased direct sales through preference-based recommendations, driving bottle sales and wine club sign-ups.
- Delivered private experiences (cellar tours, pairing dinners, group tastings), coordinating logistics and service execution.
- Supported tasting room performance by coaching junior staff on product knowledge, service standards, and upselling.
- Maintained operational readiness: stock levels, glassware standards, and tasting room/cellar presentation.

Sommelier

DEC 2023 — JUL 2024

MERTIA

- Implemented beverage inventory controls and strengthened stock management across service periods.
- Enhanced the wine list and delivered high-impact food-and-wine pairing guidance to elevate guest experience and sales.
- Developed staff wine education to improve recommendation confidence, upselling, and service consistency.
- Ensured compliance with alcohol service regulations and responsible service standards.

Tasting Room Manager (Contract)

MAY 2023 — NOV 2023

Constantia Uitsig Wine Estate

- Managed daily tasting room operations to deliver smooth, premium FOH service and consistent guest experience.
- Owned inventory management: maintained optimal stock levels, ensured uninterrupted availability, and supported efficient replenishment.
- Built strong customer relationships and delivered personalised tasting experiences, improving loyalty and repeat visits.
- Drove revenue through upselling wines and merchandise and actively curating tasting options to increase conversion.
- Completed daily cash-ups and ensured accurate handling and reconciliation of financial transactions.
- Led staff scheduling for casual team members to optimise coverage for peak trading periods and events.
- Planned and executed wine-related activations/events to strengthen brand presence and elevate the farm experience.
- Managed the wine club programme (memberships, shipments, and member events) to keep engagement high.
- Produced sales reports and trend analysis to identify top-selling products and support data-driven decisions.

Wine Steward

DEC 2019 — MAY 2023

Muratie Wine Estate

- Drove a remarkable 25% increase in wine club sign-ups since joining the tasting room team.
- Successfully improved the buying rate ratio per visitor in the tasting room, resulting in increased sales and revenue.
- Utilized effective sales techniques and persuasive communication skills to encourage guests to make purchases.
- Implemented strategic up-selling and cross-selling strategies to maximize the value of each customer transaction.

EDUCATION

Certificate in Wine

2021-10 – 2021-10

Cape Wine Academy

Level 2

2021-10 – 2021-10

Stellenbosch Wine and Spirit Educational Trust (WSET)

Bachelors in Business and IT

2021-12 – 2024-11

IU International University of Applied Sciences

Financial Accounting(Course)

2025-11 – 2026-01

Nexford University

SKILLS

FOH + sales performance

Organisational & budget discipline

Guest experience excellence

Wine expertise

Inventory Management

Communication and Storytelling

CERTIFICATIONS

Certificate in Wine

Cape Wine Academy · 2021

Level 2

HOSPITALITY PROFILE

Wine knowledge Advanced

Languages English (Fluent)